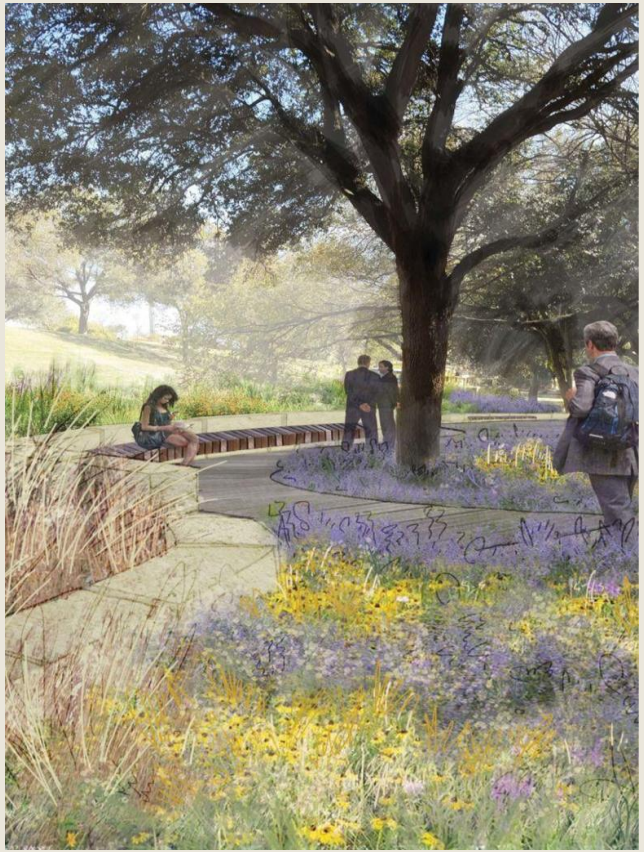


River Link

Project Proposal

Qing Hou

Big Ideas



Housing

- Affordable housing (500)
- Medium density
- Mixed use retail



Green Space

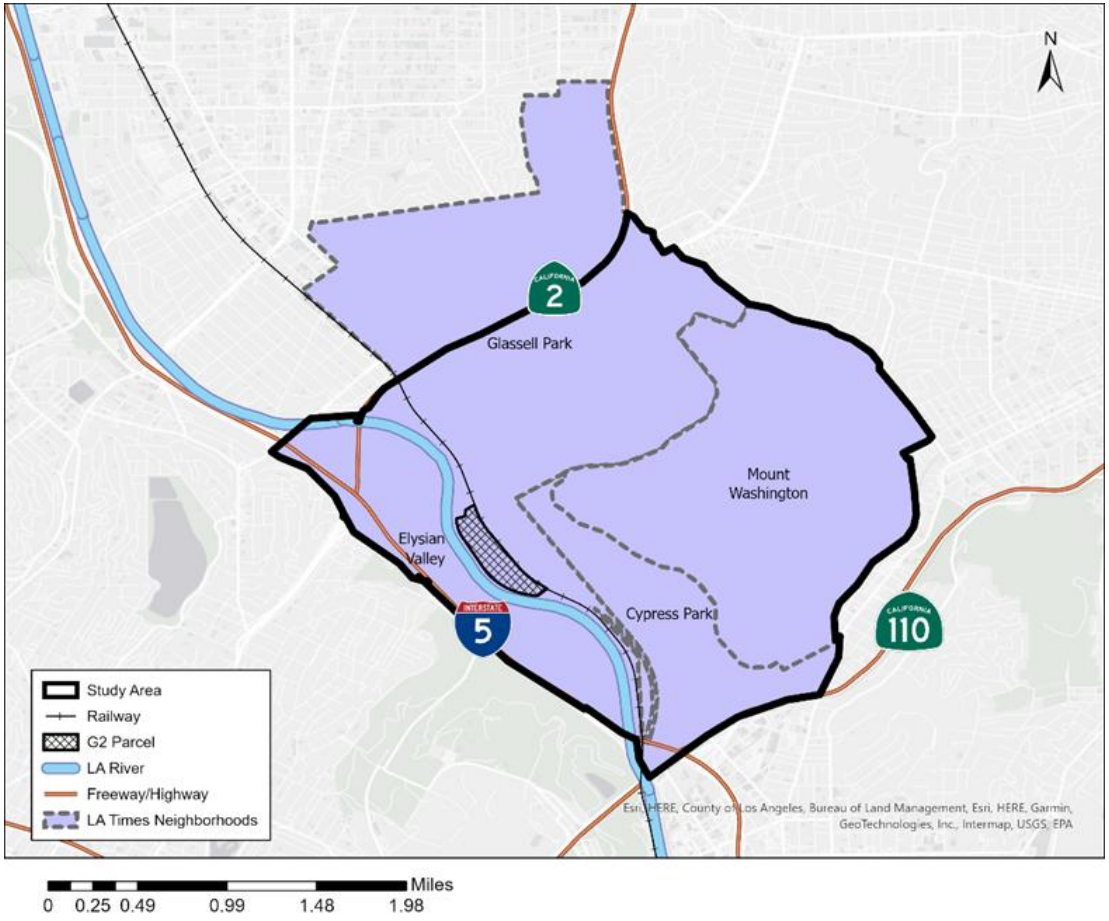
- Nature trails
- Preserved areas
- Education & Civic Spaces



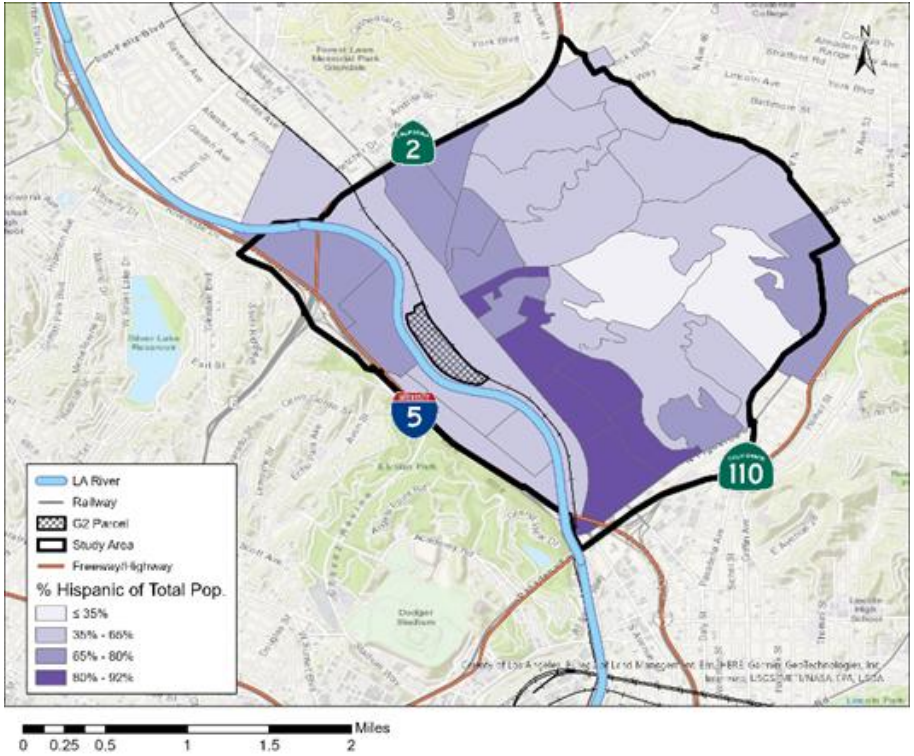
Accessibility

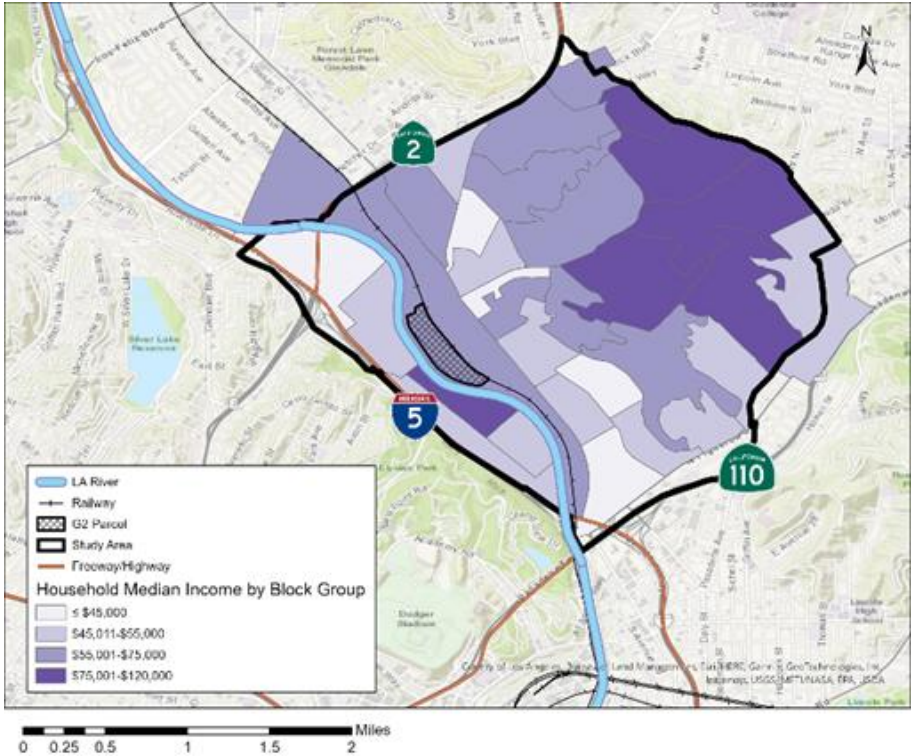
- LRT Metro station
- New pedestrian/bike bridge & bike parking
- Street & bike lane improvements

The Neighborhood



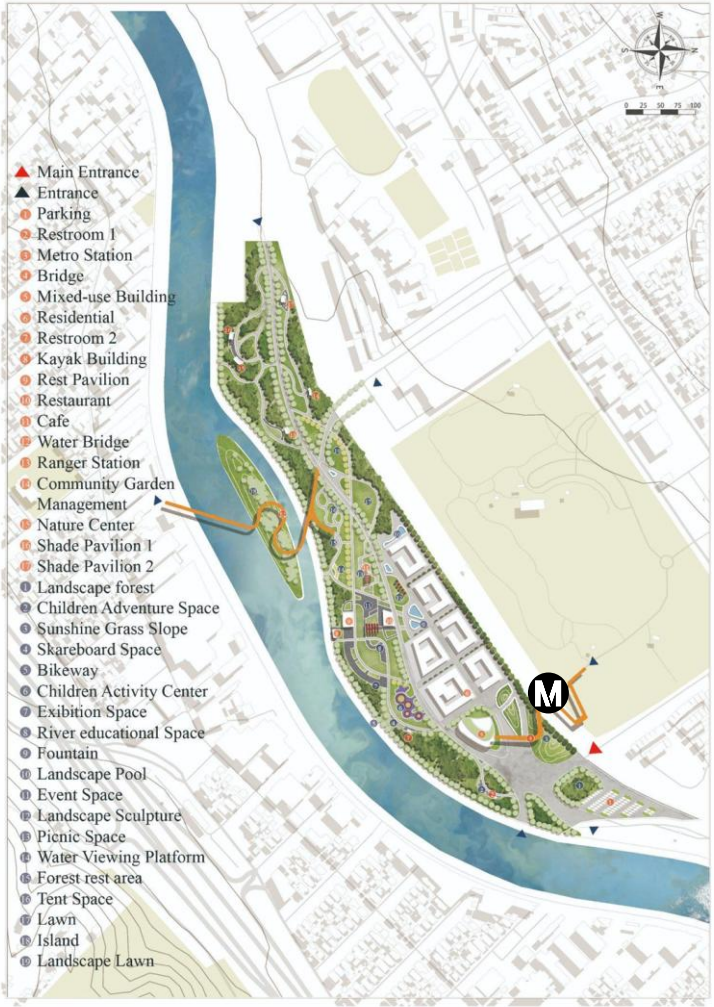
The Neighborhood



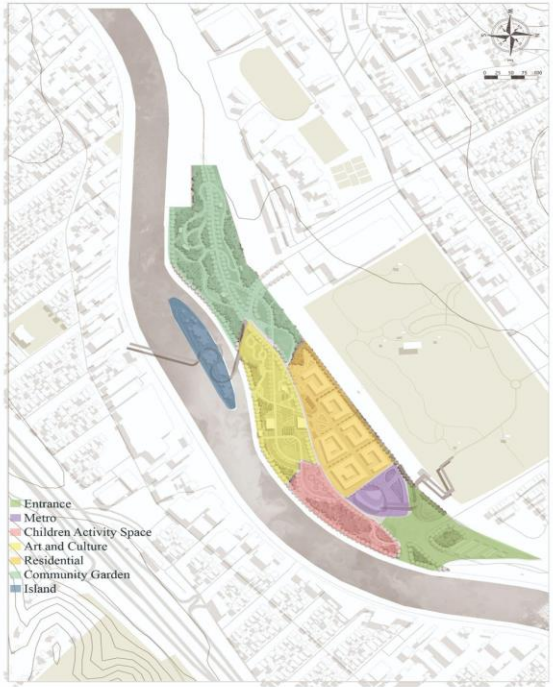


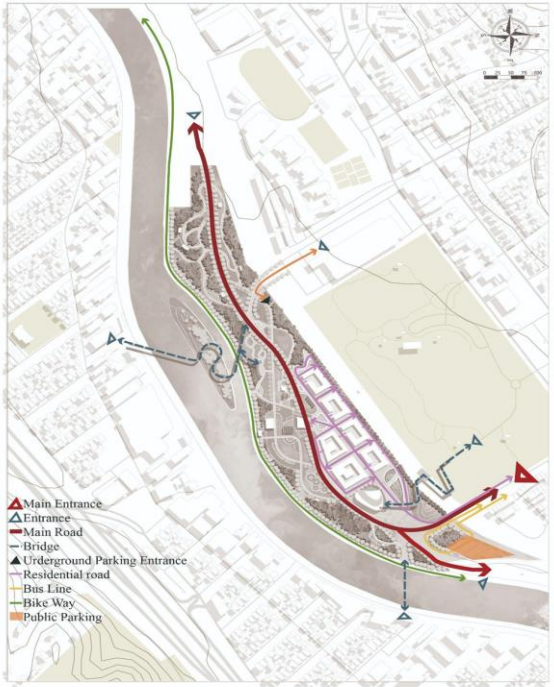
Site Plan

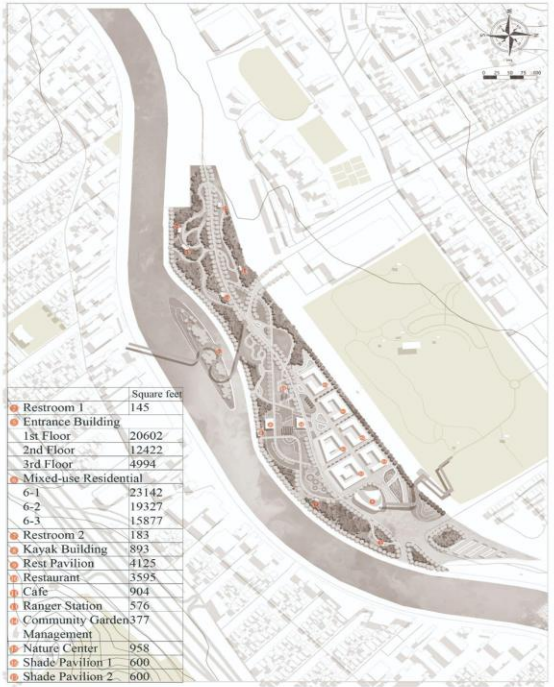



Main Entrance
Entrance
Parking
Restroom 1
Metro Station
Bridge
Mixed-use Building
Residential
Restroom 2
Kayak Building
Rest Pavilion
Restaurant
Cafe
Water Bridge
Ranger Station
Community Garden
Management
Nature Center
Shade Pavilion 1
Shade Pavilion 2
Landscape forest
Children Adventure Space
Sunshine Grass Slope
Skareboard Space
Bikeway
Children Activity Center
Exibition Space
River educational Space
Fountain
Landscape Pool
Event Space
Landscape Sculpture
Picnic Space
Water Viewing Platform
Forest rest area
Tent Space
Lawn
Island
Landscape Lawn

Site Plan Analysis





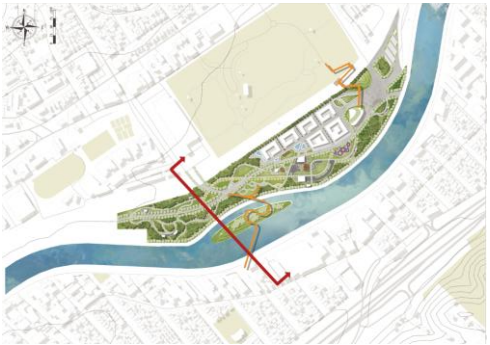


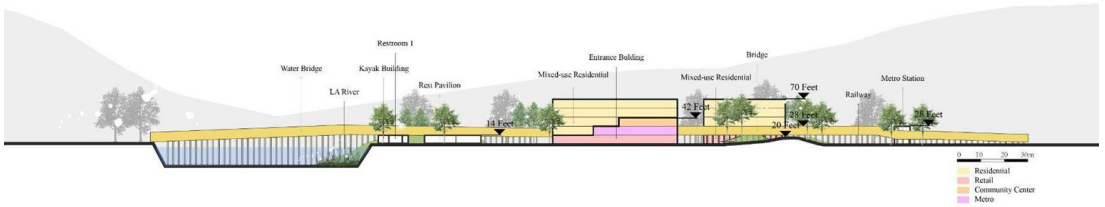
	Square feet
Restroom 1	145
Entrance Building	
1st Floor	20602
2nd Floor	12422
3rd Floor	4994
Mixed-use Residential	
6-1	23142
6-2	19327
6-3	15877
Restroom 2	183
Kayak Building	893
Rest Pavilion	4125
Restaurant	3595
Cafe	904
Ranger Station	576
Community Garden Management	377
Nature Center	958
Shade Pavilion 1	600
Shade Pavilion 2	600

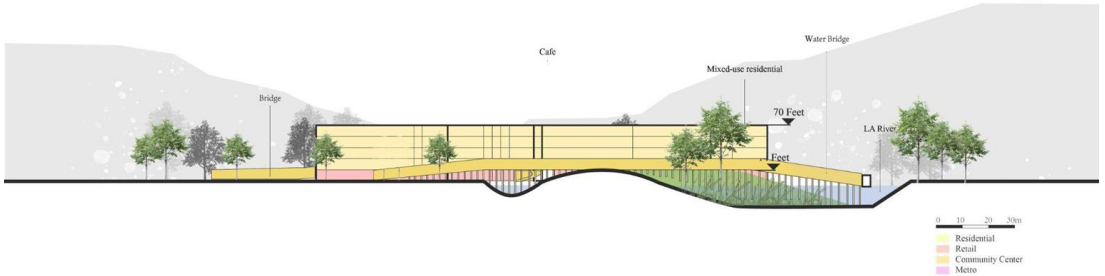
ial View

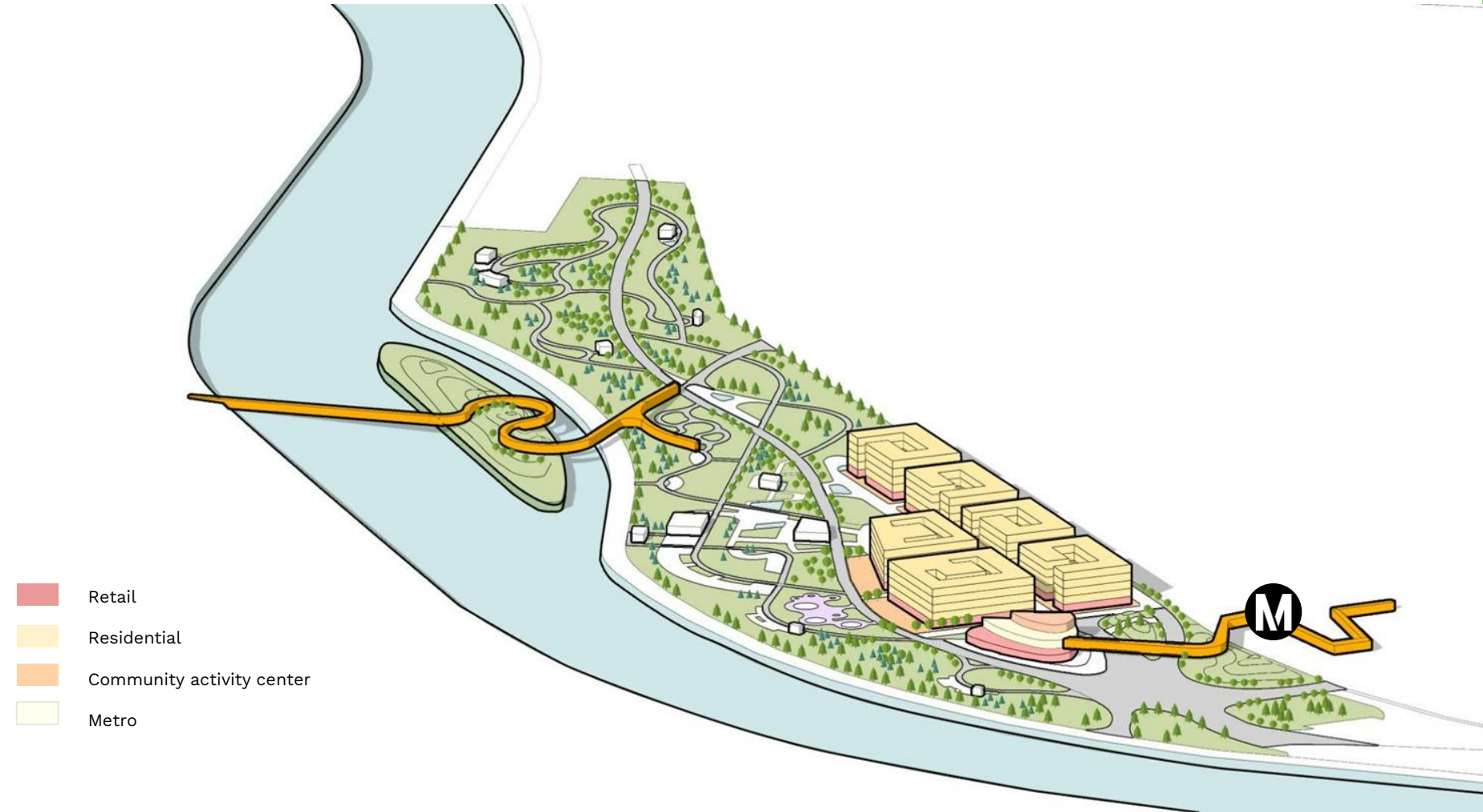
Site sections










Retail
Residential
Community activity center
Metro
M

RiverPark Station

Total Retail = 20,602 sqft

Circulation, seating, displays: 5,150 sqft

Bathrooms: 1,452 sqft

Shopping - 6,000 sqft



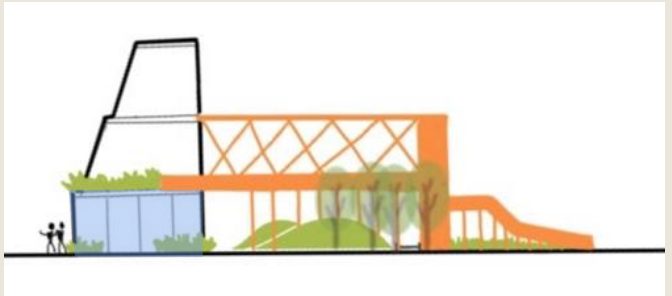
- 6 stores
- 1,000 sqft each

Food Court - 8,000 sqft



- 5 food providers 1,000 sqft each
- Eating space 3,000 sqft





HOUSING TYPOLOGY

4 Stories Podium Style

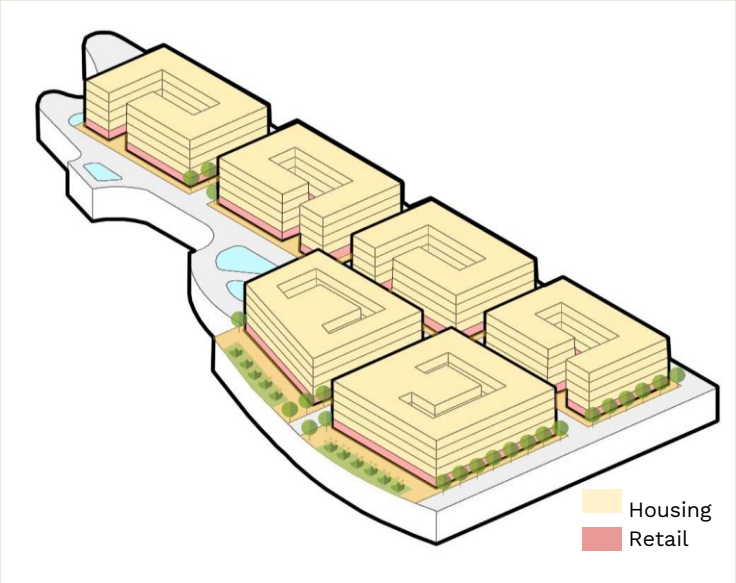
Unit mix of 30-50% AMI

500 Units

One, Two, and Three Bedroom Units

Avg Unit Size: 900 sqft

600-1,200 square feet



Zoomed in view of the housing section in the site plan.

HOUSING TYPOLOGY

200 One-Bedroom Units

600 square ft
30, 40, and 50% AMI

210 Two-Bedroom Units

800 square ft
30, 40, and 50% AMI

90 Three-Bedroom Units

1,200 square ft
30, 40, and 50% AMI

Green Roof

Native plants & species

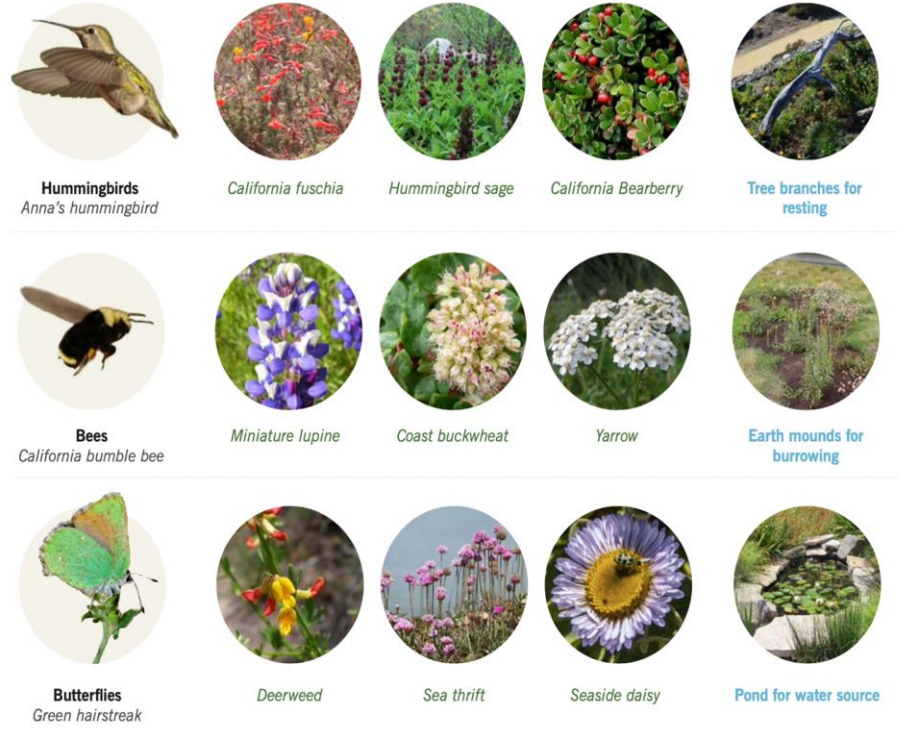
HOUSING TYPOLOGY: GREEN ROOF

Recommended Plant List

PROVEN ON NUMEROUS ROOFTOPS IN SAN FRANCISCO



Welcoming Native Species

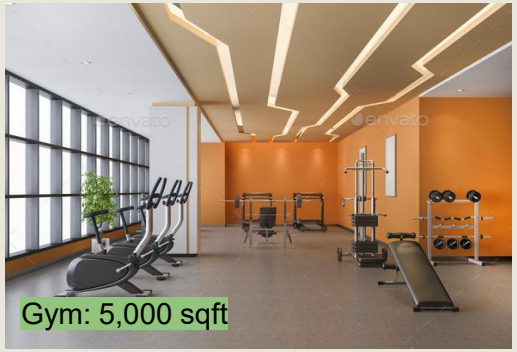


Amenities

Total Amenities Space = 23,338 sqft













Mixed-Use Buildings

6 Total Buildings

Total Retail Space = 58,346 sqft





Mixed Use Retail


Grocery Store (12,000 sqft)


Office Space (7,000 sqft)

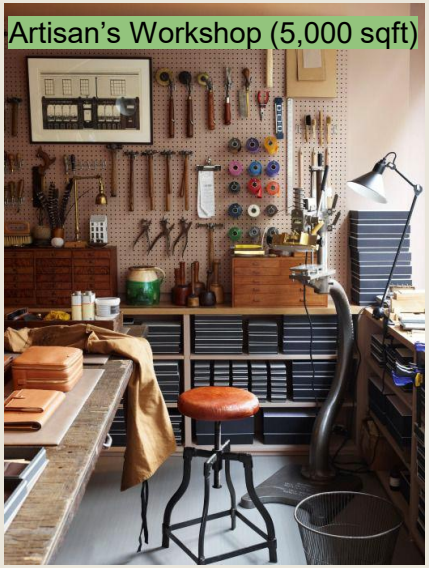

Clinic/Pharmacy (5,000 sqft)


Pet Store/Vet (3,000 sqft)


Wellness Center (4,000 sqft)


Book Store (3,000 sqft)

Mixed Use Retail cont.


Artisan's Workshop (5,000 sqft)


Artisan's Market (2,000 sqft)

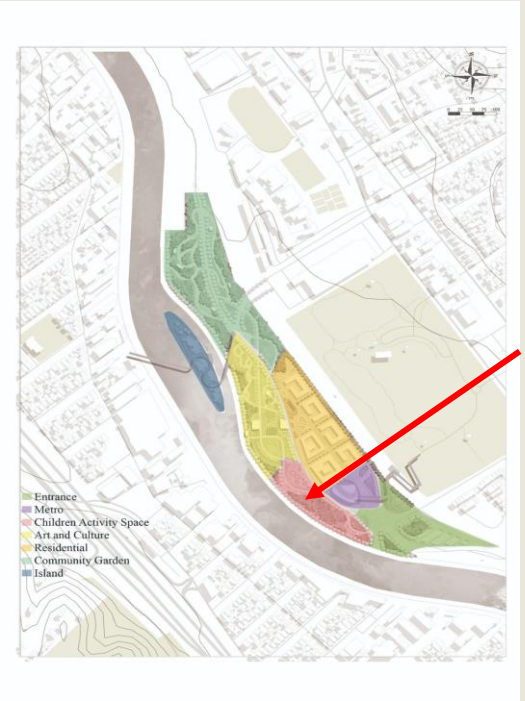

Cafe (1,500 sqft)


Cultural Restaurant (3,000 sqft)



Street Food Court (3,000 sqft)

Community Activities



Birdwatching





Kayaking



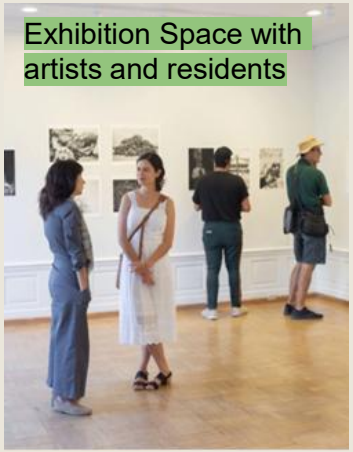


Multi-functional Pavilions


Gathering Space with cafes


Pavilion with bike path connection and lookout points


Flexible space for performance


Exhibition Space with artists and residents


Picnic Area


Pedestrian-friendly streets with green buffer

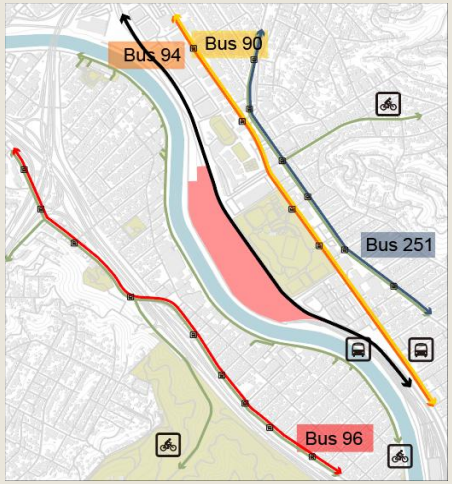

Outdoor Meeting spot

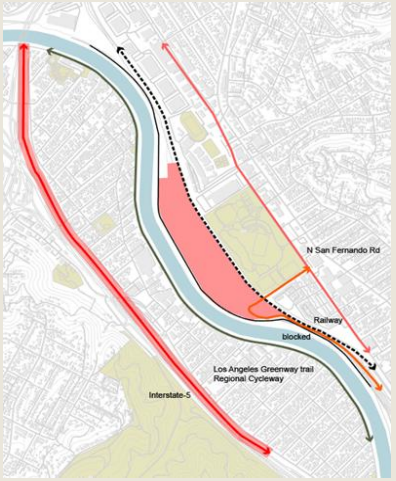

River Learning Lab

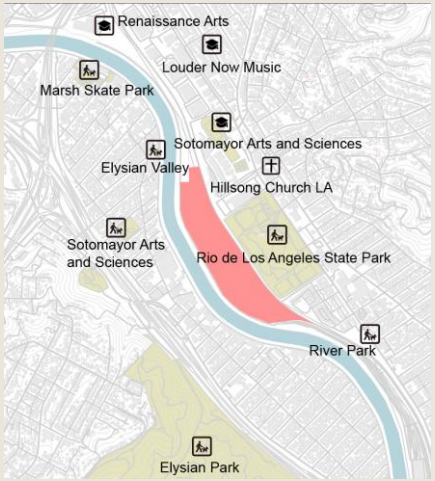
River's Edge Pavillion in Council Bluffs, U.S

Woonerf case study: John Hirsch Place in Winnipeg, Canada

Context


Bus 94
Bus 90
Bus 251
Bus 96


N San Fernando Rd
Railway
blocked
Los Angeles Greenway trail
Regional Cycleway
Interstate-5


Renaissance Arts
Louder Now Music
Marsh Skate Park
Sotomayor Arts and Sciences
Elysian Valley
Hillsong Church LA
Sotomayor Arts
and Sciences
Rio de Los Angeles State Park
River Park
Elysian Park



Context

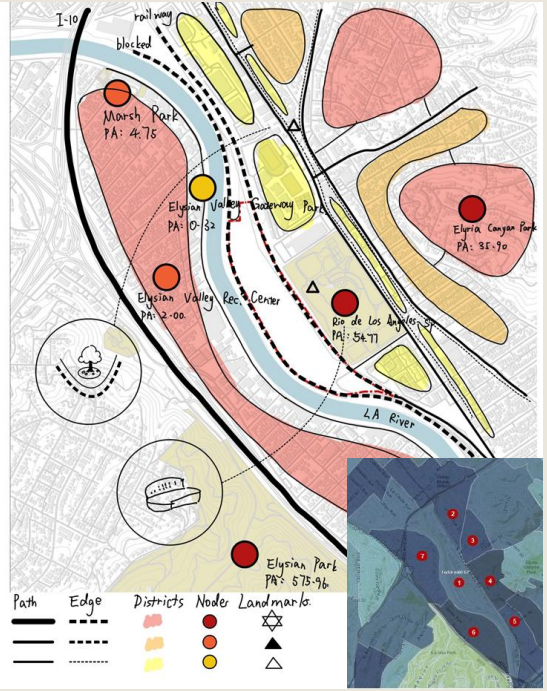


Table 3-surrounding parks amenities from Los Angeles Countywide Park analysis

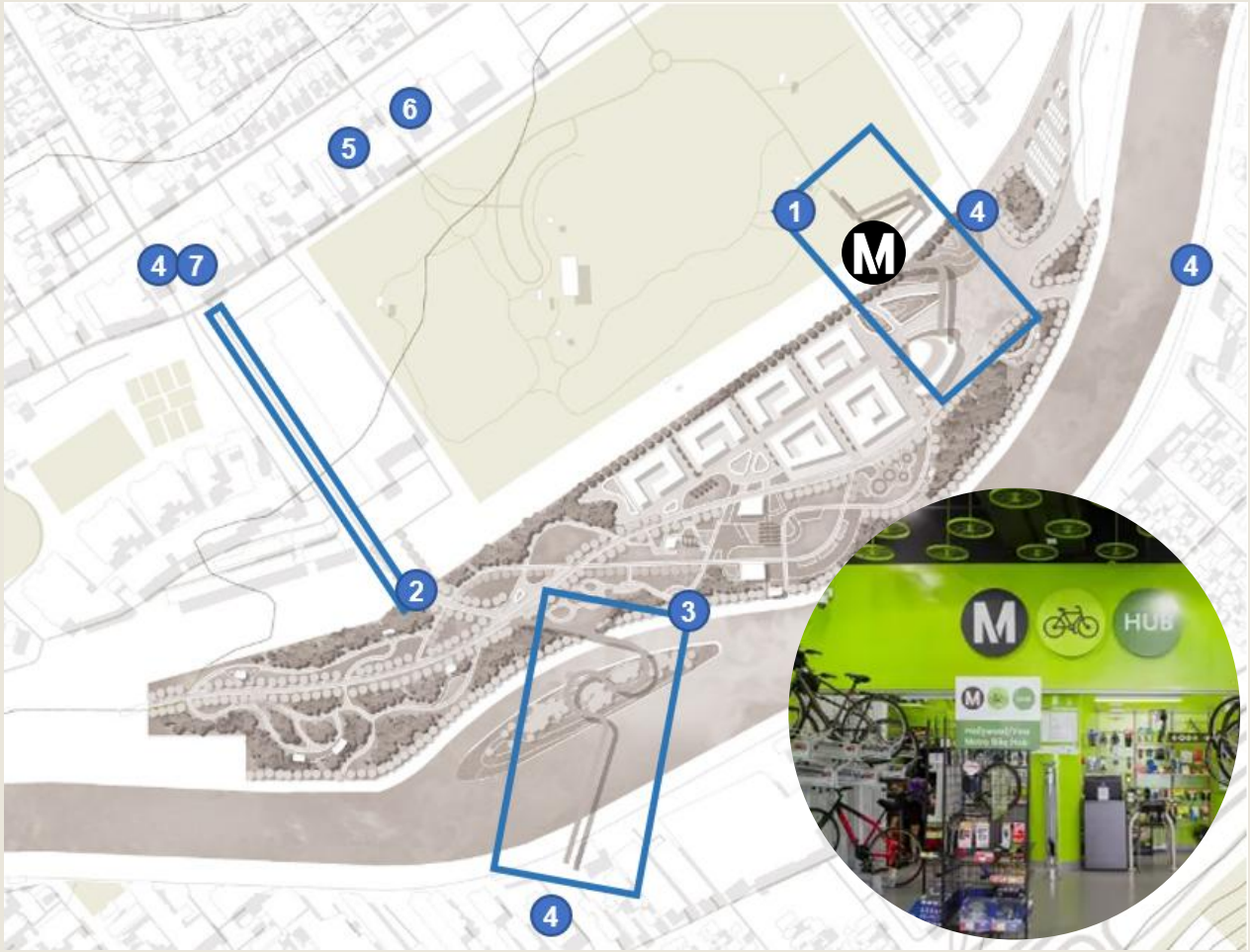
Park Name	Park acre	Tennis court	Basketball court	Baseball field	Soccer field	Multi-purpose	Picnic Shelter	Playg round	Community center	Restroom
Rio de LA SP	54.77	2	4	2	3	1	1	1	1	1
Elyria Canyan Park	35.90	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1
Elysian Park	575.96	3	2	2	0	1	13	5	0	8
Marsh park	4.75	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1
Elysian valley Rec Center	2.00	0	1	1	1	0	0	1	0	0
Elysian valley gateway	0.32	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Table 1-environmental statistic from CalEnviroScreen 4.0

	Census tract number	traffic density percentile	Groundwater threats percentile	drinking water contaminant percentile	diesel PM percentile
1	6037187102	92	96	60	92
2	6037186403	86	88	60	83
3	6037186404	29	81	60	45
4	6037185203	35	83	60	82
5	6037185320	91	69	87	82
6	6037187200	98	74	93	92
7	6037197200	100	52	96	93

Table 2-demographic statistic from CalEnviroScreen 4.0

	Census tract number	Population	Housing unit low-income units)	less than a high school education	low-income households	living below twice the federal poverty level	Unemployed
1	6037187102	3,739	1170 (650)	22% (+67%)	34% (+98%)	45% (+76%)	9% (+82%)
2	6037186403	2,698	845 (485)	30% (+80%)	30% (+80%)	35% (+62%)	6% (+59%)
3	6037186404	2,631	790 (440)	24% (+71%)	24% (+71%)	40% (+68%)	8% (+73%)
4	6037185203	3,566	935 (670)	38% (+88%)	38% (+88%)	47% (+78%)	9% (+84%)
5	6037185320	2,991	850 (665)	45% (+94%)	45% (+94%)	59% (+91%)	12% (+91%)
6	6037187200	3,909	865 (500)	25% (+76%)	25% (+76%)	36% (+63%)	7% (+66%)
7	6037197200	2,963	1175 (845)	28% (+78%)	28% (+78%)	36% (+63%)	1% (+3%)
Total		22,497	6630 (4255)				



Transportation Improvements

1. River Park Metro LRT Relocation
2. New Street through FedEx Parcel
3. Bike and Pedestrian Connection with Frogtown
4. Metro Bike Share Stations
5. Complete Streets Transformation of Cypress and San Fernando
6. Class 1 Bike Lanes
7. Pedestrianization of Small Segment of Division

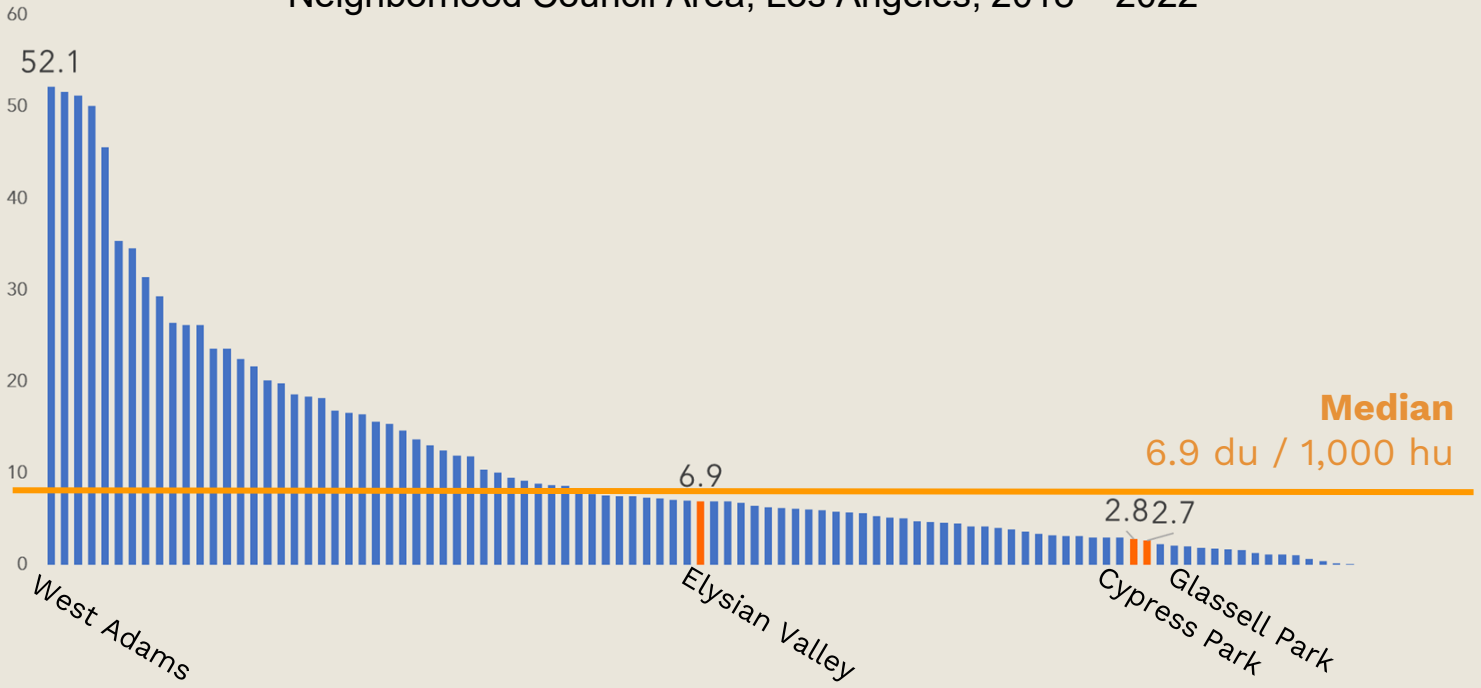


Proposed Bike Connections

- Access to Atwater Village, Glendale
- Access to Downtown LA
- Access to Echo Park/Silver Lake
- Acceleration of LA County Bike Master Plan

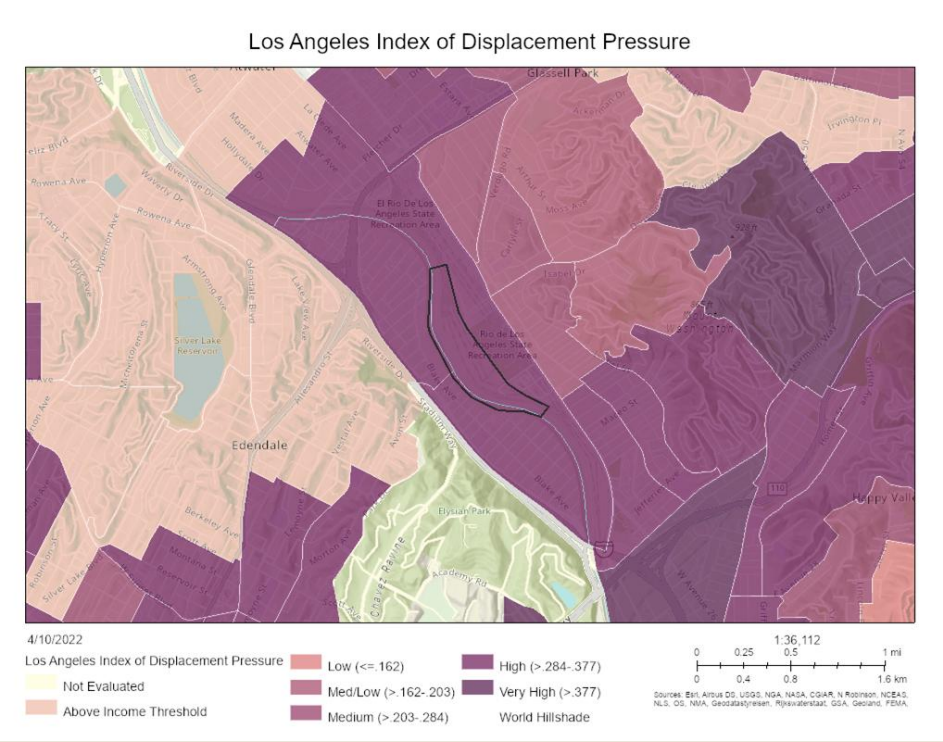
Why Build Housing?

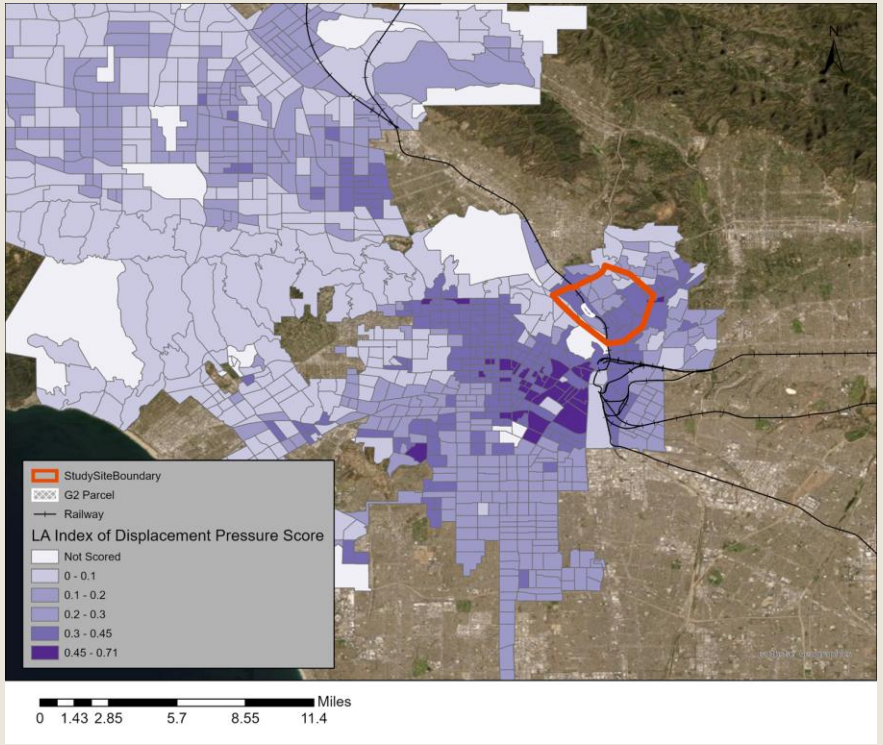
New Dwelling Units Constructed per 1,000 Existing Housing Units by Neighborhood Council Area, Los Angeles, 2018 – 2022



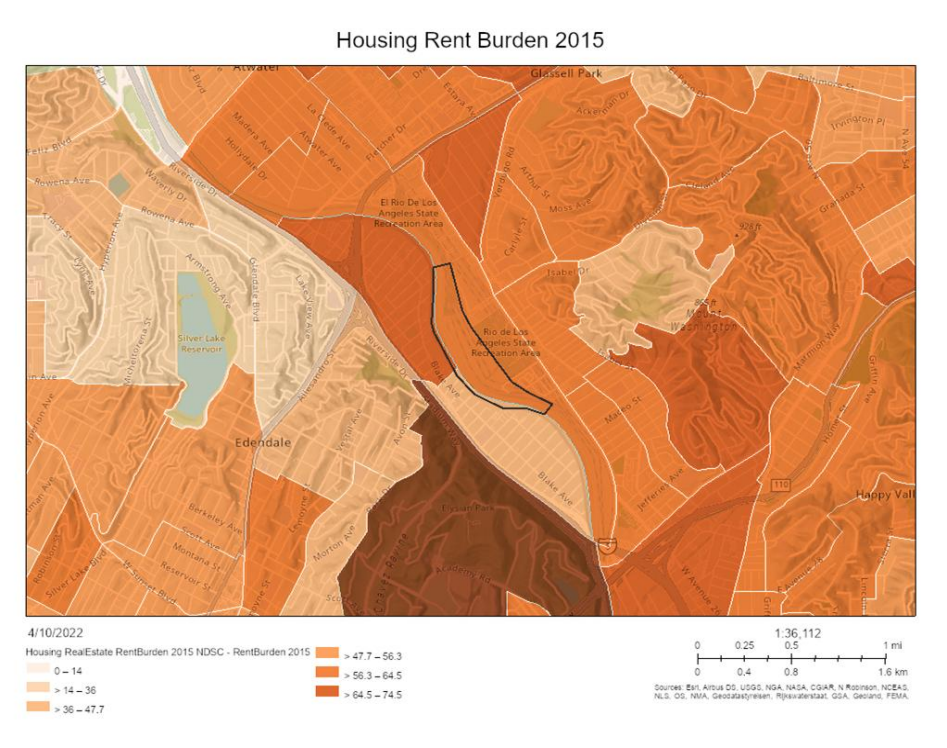
Source: City of Los Angeles DBS Permit Records from LA Open Data Portal 2022, US Census Bureau Table H1 (Decennial Census 2020)

Gentrification Risk





Housing Burden



Housing Burden

> 56.3 – 64.5
Population of Tract: **3,107**

Percent Renters: **60.67%**

Percent of Households Paying >50% of Income on Rent: **30.43%**

LA Average in 2015-2016: **49.52**

Why Build Open and Cultural Space?

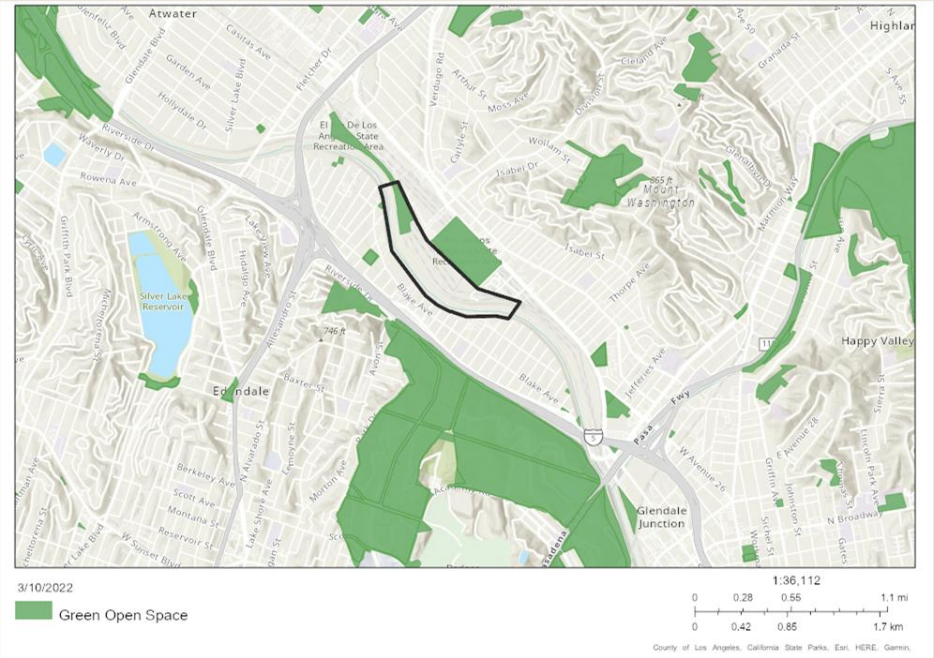
River cultural assets preservation

- Rich indigenous history and culture
- Celebrate diverse community identities around Taylor Yard
- Arts program with neighboring school districts e.g. LA River Project: creating tiles for a bench in Rio de Los Angeles State Park

LA County Arts and Cultural initiative

- “Percent for art” policy for private construction and development projects to invest in public art
- Focus on inclusive programs and equity
- Learning from the success of the bowtie project
- Mapping of arts initiatives along the LA River

Access to Green Space



Restricted by freeways

Now: Limited access to Elysian Park by the Interstate 5 freeway

Future: Combining with Rio de Los Angeles State Park and bowtie parcel to create a larger green space for surrounding community

How and why: Environmental Remediation

Contamination

- The Source of Contamination:
  - Maintenance, operation of railroad cars.
  - Facilities: diesel shop, roundhouse
- These can cause soil and groundwater contamination with petroleum hydrocarbons, metals, and volatile organic compounds.



Cleanup Plan I

For Residential:

- Excavation of soil in impacted areas at depths from 2.5 to 5 feet and off-site disposal.
- Covering the contaminated soils with concrete or pavement to prevent exposure.
- Installation of vapor barrier and sub slab venting system under building slabs.
- Ongoing operation of SVE system and groundwater monitoring.

Cleanup Plan II

For Commercial and Green space:

- Excavation of soil in impacted areas to a depth of 10 feet and off-site disposal.
- Use pavement or the clean soil from other site.
- Ongoing operation of SVE system and groundwater monitoring.

Wetland Habitat

- Wetlands trap pollutants such as heavy metals in their soils, and physically and chemically break down bacteria.
- Methods:
  - Collecting rainwater and maintaining river levels.
  - Introduce California native plants to enrich plant diversity.
  - Provide habitat for wildlife.





Xiaoyu Dai

DEVELOPMENT COST & GAP FUNDING

	10-Year Period	Annual
Development Cost	$210,000,000	$21,000,000
4% LIHTC Equity	$147,000,000	$14,700,000
Gap Funding	$63,000,000	$6,300,000

Possible Gap Funding Sources:

- California HCD (Infill, Multifamily Housing, TOD)
- EPA Grants (Brownfield development)
- Municipal Bonds



Zoomed in view of the housing section in the site plan.

Project Costs

Total Project Cost Estimate

Subtotal Site Remediation	$	199,180,000
Subtotal Park Improvements and Facilities	$	141,000,000
Mixed-Use Village Development Cost	$	210,000,000
Other Facilities	$	25,487,000
Escalation	$	62,975,000
Contingency	$	33,946,000
LADWP Power Line Relocation	$	22,393,000
New Pedestrian and Bike Bridge	$	36,800,000
Total	**$**	**731,781,000**

Source: Taylor Yard River Park Technical Report, Table 12-2, Class C Estimate, 2021

Stakeholders and Potential Partners









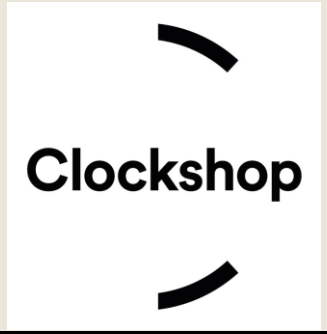












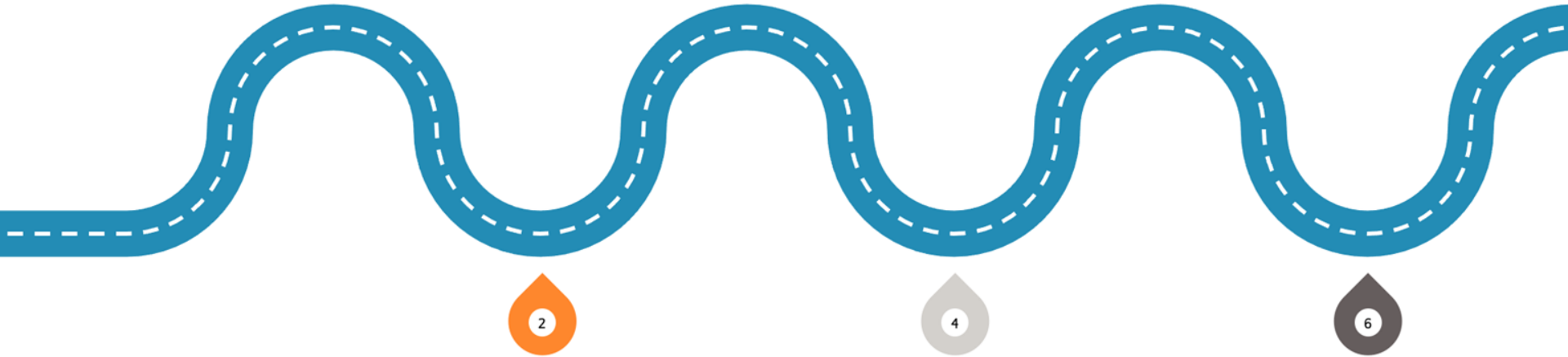






Outreach Plan

1. Conversation with nonprofit organizations and residents; Join community meetings
2. Build a website for public information and inquiry; establish our official accounts on social media
3. Organize activity with local schools and invest in after-school research programs near the River
4. Listen to the needs of our partners from both public and private sectors
5. Initiation stage: invite neighboring communities to join our grand opening
6. Mitigate any potential risks and adjust our operation



Timeline

Operation/Assessment

We will invite nonprofits and public/private organizations to give evaluations and feedback for our site.

Olympics

We aim to draw funding from the City to carry out the next phase of our development

2023 — 2024 — 2025 — 2026 — 2027 — 2028 — 2029 — 2030

Start Operation

We aim to start cleaning and constructing fixtures on our site by the end of next year

Mitigation

We will conduct any mitigation after research and assessment

Housing Construction

We aim to secure funding for housing construction and prepare for lease-up